

Food

Unit 5 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Talk about food, quantities, food labels, and ordering meals.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Talk about food I like and eat
- ✓ Use a/an, some and any with countable and uncountable nouns
- ✓ Use a lot of, much and many
- ✓ Ask How many / How much for quantities
- ✓ Talk about food labels and healthy eating
- ✓ Order a meal in a restaurant

4 lessons in this unit

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Topics: food · countable/uncountable · /t/ or /d/

Vocabulary — Food

cheese	chicken	chips	eggs
fish	juice	lamb	lemons
lentils	nuts	onions	oranges
pasta	peppers	potatoes	prawns
raisins	rice	salt	pepper

Popular dishes: pizza (Italy), ceviche (Peru), satay (Indonesia), kabsa (Saudi Arabia), pierogi (Poland), curry (India).

Pronunciation — /t/ vs /d/

/t/ is voiceless (as in "chicken", "cheese"). /d/ is voiced (as in "juice", "orange").

- /t/ — chicken, cheese, church, watch
- /d/ — juice, orange, general, large

Countable vs uncountable nouns + a/an, some, any

Countable nouns can be counted (one egg, two eggs). Uncountable nouns can't be counted (some water — NOT "two waters").

a / an	singular COUNTABLE: an onion, a banana
some	PLURAL countable AND UNCOUNTABLE — in POSITIVE sentences: some onions, some water
any	PLURAL countable AND UNCOUNTABLE — in NEGATIVE sentences and QUESTIONS: any carrots, any bread

Examples:

- Cook the chicken with an onion. (singular countable)
- You need some meat and some onions and tomatoes. (some + positive)
- I don't use any carrots. (any + negative)
- Do you have any bread? (any + question)

Topics: food markets · a lot of / much / many · quantities and containers · how much/how many

Vocabulary — Quantities and containers

a bag of rice	a bottle of water/sauce	a glass of water	a kilo of flour
a packet of pasta	a piece of pizza	a slice of cake	a tin of tuna

Famous markets in Unit 5b: St Lawrence (Toronto), Castries (Saint Lucia), Kreta Ayer (Singapore), La Vucciria (Palermo, Italy), Borough Market (London — 1,000 years old).

a lot of / much / many

a lot of — works with countable AND uncountable, mainly in POSITIVES. much/many — mainly in NEGATIVES and QUESTIONS.

a lot of	countable plural + uncountable (positive sentences)
many	countable plural (negatives & questions)
much	uncountable (negatives & questions)

Examples:

- There are a lot of shops here. / There's a lot of food.
- There aren't many markets. / There isn't much food.
- Do you eat a lot of / many apples? — No, not many.
- Do you eat a lot of / much cheese? — No, not much.

How many / How much

Ask "How many" with countable plural nouns. Ask "How much" with uncountable nouns.

Examples:

- How many bananas do you want? — Six, please.
- How much rice do you want? — A kilo.
- How many tins of tuna do you need? — Four tins.
- How much cheese would you like? — Half a kilo, please.

Topics: food labels · word focus: mean

Vocabulary — Food labels

superfood	natural	best before	low fat
calorie	portion	ingredients	vitamins
traffic lights (red/orange/green)			

Don't trust the word "superfood" — anyone can use it. "Best before" = the food is best before this date, but you CAN still eat it afterwards. Low-fat food often has lots of sugar!

Word focus: mean

"Mean" has different uses depending on context.

Examples:

- Red MEANS the food is unhealthy. (= shows / signals)
- The word "healthy" MEANS the food is good for you. (= explains a word)
- Do you know what I MEAN? (= asking for understanding)
- I see what you MEAN. (= I understand)
- Your pizza is delicious. I MEAN it! (= I'm serious)
- We went out last Friday — I MEAN last Saturday. (= correcting yourself)

Lesson 5d · At the restaurant + instructions + world food quiz

Topics: menus · ordering a meal · contracted forms · writing instructions · video lesson · world food

Vocabulary — Menus (5d)

Starters (1st course)	Main courses (2nd, biggest)	Desserts (sweet finish)	Drinks
garlic bread	soup	salad	pizza
burger	fries	smoothie	bottle of water
iced tea			

Vocabulary — Video — World food quiz (5f)

street food	spicy	sweet	sour
salty	fresh	vegetarian	

Pronunciation — Contracted forms (5d)

In restaurant orders, contractions sound natural: I'd = I would, I'll = I will.

- I'd /aɪd/ like a coffee.
- I'll /aɪl/ have a pizza.

Real life — Ordering a meal (5d)

Common phrases when ordering food in a restaurant.

Examples:

- Here is the menu. (waiter)
- Can I get you anything to drink first? (waiter)
- I'd like a bottle of water, please.
- I don't want a starter.
- I'll have a seafood pizza.
- I'd also like a dessert.
- Are you ready to order? (waiter)
- That was delicious.
- Can I get you anything else? (waiter)
- Could we have the bill, please?

Writing skill — Instructions (5e)

Recipes and instructions use the IMPERATIVE form (base verb, no subject). Use simple, clear language.

Examples:

- Cook the chicken with an onion.
- Add some salt and pepper.
- Serve with rice.
- Don't use too much oil.